

Thoracic Penetrating Wound

Inclusion Criteria

1. Thoracic Penetrating Injury
2. Patients <16 years of age

Prehospital arrest and/or pulseless on arrival?

No

Yes

1. Airway/oxygenate
2. MTP
3. Bilateral finger thoracostomies
4. Control of any obvious active bleeding

Signs of life?*

No

Yes

Terminate resuscitation and pronounce dead

Improvement in condition?

Yes

No

ED thoracotomy

OR for thoracotomy

Profound shock and/or bradycardia for age**?

Yes

No

Support airway, breathing and circulation as indicated

CXR

Pericardial FAST

Negative

Equivocal

Positive

Pericardial Window

Negative

Positive

Hemothorax or Pneumothorax

Yes

No

Chest tube(s)

Immediate drainage of >25% of estimated blood volume?

Yes

No

Follow pericardial FAST pathway

Follow CXR pathway

CT scan chest (aortic protocol) if CXR and pericardial FAST both negative

OR for Sternotomy esophagoscopy, bronchoscopy

***Signs of Life:**
spontaneous motor or respirations, reactive pupils, narrow complex EKG rhythm or organized cardiac motion

**Profound Shock by Age

- 0-1 month:** SBP <60 mm Hg; HR <110 or >180
1-12 month: SBP <70 mm Hg; HR <100 or >170
1-10 years: SBP <70 mm Hg + (age x 2); HR <60 or >140
>10 years: SBP <90; HR <60 or >110